Casey Caster

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Enterprise portfolio and technology operations executive with 15+ years in program management, transformation, and delivery leadership in enterprise SaaS, cloud infrastructure, and fintech. Chief of staff to the CPO and then the CTO at SingleStore, a B2B SaaS company in hypergrowth: cut internal cloud spend 50%, built a COGS intelligence engine with Finance, negotiates vendor contracts including LLM token pricing, and leads internal GenAI adoption and governance. Built Ripple's global implementation function from 4 project managers to an organization delivering 800+ implementations. PMP; Executive MBA.

Core Competencies

- **Enterprise PMO, Portfolio Management & Governance**: Built Ripple's global program management function from the ground up; led Autodesk portfolio optimization across 150+ projects ($2M+ savings); led an upgrade of Wells Fargo's project portfolio systems for 10,000+ vendors.
- **Tech Spend Optimization & Finance Partnership**: Cut internal cloud spend 50%; manages the engineering budget with Finance; built a COGS intelligence engine that ties growth trends to investment decisions.
- **Vendor & Contract Governance**: Negotiates vendor contracts, including LLM token pricing; negotiated and fulfilled SOWs and MSAs with enterprise financial institutions.
- **Capacity Planning & Executive Reporting**: Runs engineering capacity planning and delivery dashboards for engineering leadership; acts as chief of staff to the CTO.
- **Internal AI Deployment & Change Management**: Drove internal GenAI adoption through a governance and ops program; leads AI tooling, including Claude Code, across the development stack; agile transformation (5x velocity).
- **Risk Management & Escalation**: Rescued a failing strategic partner integration through a cross-functional realignment, unlocking $30M+ in recurring ARR; led M&A technical due diligence and integration.

Professional Experience

- **SingleStore** **San Francisco, CA**
  Sr Director, Engineering - Internal Services & Technical Program Management (CTO Chief of Staff) *2021-Present*
  Strategy and operations for a cloud-native database company in hypergrowth, reporting to the CPO and then the CTO. Leads seven teams through a director, two managers, a TPM who runs quality assurance, and two principal architects (32 people). Owns cost optimization, M&A, governance, and AI platform operations programs.
  - **Cut internal cloud spend by 50%** through cross-team policy reform and usage modeling.
  - **Manages the engineering budget with Finance**; built a COGS intelligence engine that aligns growth trends with operational investment decisions.
  - **Negotiates with vendors**, including LLM token pricing, and analyzes mergers.
  - **Drove internal GenAI adoption** with a governance and ops program, creating and launching internal platforms; leads AI tooling, including Claude Code, across the development stack.
  - **Runs engineering capacity planning and delivery dashboards** for engineering leadership.
  - **Unlocked $30M+ in recurring ARR** by rescuing a failing strategic partner integration through a cross-functional realignment.
  - **Increased engineering velocity 5x** through agile transformation and accountability systems.
  - **Launched an internal development platform**, reducing infrastructure bottlenecks by 70%.
  - **De-risked M&A** by leading technical due diligence, then integrating acquired teams into core systems and workflows.

- **Ripple, Inc.** **San Francisco, CA**
  Global Head of Program Management, Customer Success *2016-2020*
  Promoted to lead global delivery programs for RippleNet and architect the implementation function.
  - **Delivered 800+ global implementations**, with 250+ running concurrently; grew the team from 4 project managers to three managers of project management and 25 project managers, plus 75+ engineers and architects led indirectly.
  - **Cut customer delivery time from eight months to eight weeks** across RippleNet implementations.
  - **Created the RippleNet Committee**, a global governance body, negotiating with C-suite executives of major banks.
  - **Negotiated and fulfilled SOWs and MSAs** with enterprise financial institutions; oversaw a joint venture in Japan that delivered implementations at 68+ additional banks.
- **Wells Fargo Bank** **San Francisco, CA**
  Senior Program Manager *2014-2015*
  - **Led an upgrade of project portfolio systems** for 10,000+ vendors.
  - **Delivered a $20M+ digital transformation initiative**, coordinating 300+ testers.
- **Autodesk** **San Francisco, CA**
  Senior Program Manager, Head of Continuous Improvement *2013-2014*
  - **Led portfolio optimization with $2M+ in savings** and improved user satisfaction.
  - Analyzed 150+ projects and delivered recommendations to improve efficiency and employee engagement.
- **Engajer** **Mountain View, CA**
  Head of Customer Success *2012-2013*
  - Built and led programs supporting 850+ customers; increased revenue 20% per account with 85% retention.
- **Avanade** **San Francisco, CA**
  Senior Consultant *2010-2012*
  - Led requirements for new CRM systems; delivered CRM and communications transformations in utilities and healthcare.

Selected Accomplishments

- **Established Ripple's payments network governance**: membership scheme, governing body, and business rules; enrolled the first 12 banks and grew membership past 200.
- **Implemented a $4M virtual testing network program** with teams in Bangalore and London, saving hundreds of person-hours per test cycle.
- **Mentored dozens of team members**, three of whom became CEOs at other companies.

Education & Certifications

- **Project Management Professional (PMP)**, Project Management Institute
- **Executive MBA**, Cornell University (Johnson) and Queen's University (Smith), dual degree
- **BS, Electronic Engineering Technology**, DeVry University, Pomona, CA

References

- Available upon request.